

Tufan Neupane

Graduate Student, Master of Mass Communication

Walter Cronkite School of Journalism and Mass Communication, Arizona State University

Email: tneupane@asu.edu

Nepali journalist with 15 years of experience reporting on the judiciary, criminal justice, environment, politics, and human rights. 2023 Fulbright Hubert H. Humphrey Fellow at the Walter Cronkite School of Journalism and Mass Communication, Arizona State University, recently completed my capstone assignment at the Cronkite News Washington, DC bureau. Specializes in investigative reporting and data journalism.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Digital Reporter, Cronkite News – Washington, D.C. Bureau, 08/2025–12/2025

- Covered U.S. federal policy, political developments, and Congressional proceedings with an Arizona perspective.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Cronkite School of Journalism, ASU, 08/2024–05/2025

- Reporter, Howard Center for Investigative Journalism: published an investigative report on a Phoenix Police civilian shooting.
- Reporter, Borderlands Reporting Project, Panama: published in-depth reporting on how Panama, with limited national capacity to resist strong geopolitical forces, finds itself caught between two superpowers – the U.S. and China.
- Society of Environmental Journalists Student Reporting Fellow 2025.
- Launched and curated a monthly newsletter for the Cronkite Global Initiative, overseeing the Humphrey Fellowship, to boost engagement among fellows, alumni, and the Cronkite School community.

Hubert H. Humphrey Fellow, Journalism & Human Rights, Arizona State University & University of Kansas, 06/2023–06/2024

- Completed advanced coursework in data journalism, depth reporting, and OSINT.
- Participated in narrative writing workshops and Investigative Reporters and Editors (IRE) training sessions.
- Produced and presented human rights research at university seminars.

Professional Placements during Fellowship:

- Summer Fellow, Invisible Institute – Chicago, IL, 05/2024–06/2024: Collaborated with investigative journalism team on data reporting related to police misconduct and excessive force during peaceful protests; researched Pulitzer-winning community-centered journalism projects.
- *Intern, Arizona Justice Project, Phoenix, AZ*, 10/2023–12/2023: Wrote compelling profiles of wrongfully imprisoned individuals for the Arizona Justice Project's website.

Sr. Sub-Editor, Kantipur National Daily, Kathmandu, Nepal, 01/2021–Present (*Study leave: 06/2023–12/2025*)

- Report on the Supreme Court, parliament, constitutional bodies, law enforcement, and human rights violations.
- Produce investigative stories shaping public discourse on governance and justice.

Special Correspondent, Himal Media, Kathmandu, Nepal, 01/2010–12/2020 (*Study leave: 09/2016–06/2018*)

- Covered national news as an investigative reporter, focusing on the Supreme Court, parliament, constitutional bodies, law enforcement, and human rights violations.

EDUCATION

- The Lede Program for Data Journalism, Columbia Journalism School, Columbia University, New York, USA, 2025
- Master of Mass Communication (Expected Dec 2025), Walter Cronkite School of Journalism and Mass Communication, Arizona State University, Phoenix, USA
 - **Summer Study Abroad:** Certified Program in Sports Journalism & Communications, Universidad Europea de Madrid, Spain, 2025
- LLM, International Law, University of International Business and Economics, Beijing, China, 2018
- LLB, Butwal Multiple Campus, Tribhuvan University, Butwal, Nepal, 2013

SCHOLARSHIPS & FELLOWSHIPS

- Full Scholarship for The LEDE Program for Data Journalism, Columbia Journalism School, 2025
- Cronkite School Graduate Scholarship, International Student Scholarship, and Merit Scholarship, ASU, 2025
- Graduate Teaching Assistantship, Walter Cronkite School of Journalism and Mass Communication, ASU, 2024
- Hubert H. Humphrey Fellowship (U.S. Department of State), ASU, 2023
- Investigative Reporting Fellowship, Centre for Investigative Journalism (CIJ), Nepal, 2014, 2016, 2019, 2022, 2023

AWARDS

- Best Reporter of the Year, Kantipur Daily, Nepal, 2022
- Gender Equality Journalism Award, Forum of Women Journalists, Nepal, 2015
- Competitive Investigative Journalism Campaign Award, CIJ Nepal & British Embassy to Nepal, 2015

STORY GRANTS

- "In the Tracks of Asia's Snow Leopard Trafficking Syndicates," Wild Eye Asia, 2021
- Asia-Pacific Story Grant, Earth Journalism Network, 2021
- Media Fellowship for Environmental Reporting, Wild Eye Asia, 2021
- Collaborative Reporting Fellowship, Investigative Multimedia Journalism Network, 2020
- Media Fellowship on Climate Change Reporting, The Energy and Resources Institute (TERI), India, 2020
- Fellowship for Reporting the Ecology and Economy of the Transboundary Mahakali River Basin, The Third Pole, and Oxfam, 2019

AFFILIATIONS

- Member, Center for Investigative Journalism (CIJ), Nepal (Since 2016)
- Member, Investigative Reporters and Editors (IRE), US (Since 2023)
- Member, Society of Environmental Journalists (SEJ), US (Since 2025)
- Member, South Asian Journalists Association (SAJA), US (Since 2025)